Earthquake is one of those type of natural disaster that strike without an early warning signal. An earthquake is the result of the sudden break within the uppercrest of the earth, which may also break the surface and lead to the vibration of the ground.



The world's largest earthquake with an instrumentally documented magnitude occurred on May 22nd 1960 near Valdivia in Southern Chile. It was assigned a magnitude of 9.5

What to do before hand

- Build in accordance with urban planning the regulations for risk areas.
- Ensure that all electrical and gas appliance in the house together with all pipes connected to them are firmly fixed.
- Avoid storing heavy objects and materials in high altitude.
- Hold family evacuation drills and ensure that the whole family knows what to do in case of an earthquake.
- Prepare a family emergency kit.

During an Earthquake

- Keep people calm – do not get panic.
- People who are indoors should stay there but move to the central part of the building.
- Keep away from the stairs, which might collapse suddenly.
- People who are outside should be away from buildings and collapsing walls and away from electric cables.
- Anyone in a vehicle should park it, away from bridges and buildings.

After an Earthquake

- Check if you or anyone else is hurt. Use first-aid for cuts and bruises.
- Keep the streets clear for emergency services.
- Switch off all appliances like the refrigerator, Television or Radio
- Turn off the gas (LPG).
- Wear shoes to protect your feet from debris.
- A battery-operated radio will help you to get important messages.
- Be prepared for more shocks.



Earthquakes occur most frequently in plate boundaries.

8.2.4 Fire Accident

A fire is defined as undesirable event which emits heat, smoke and or flame, which has the potential to cause damage either mechanical or manmade.

Some of the causes are:

1. Cooking equipment
2. Heating
3. Smoking in bedrooms
4. Candles
5. Curious Children
6. Faulty wiring
7. Flammable liquids
8. Ignorance, carelessness, faulty handling, indifference and recklessness of people

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